

Global Retail Solutions — Customer Support, Order Management & Refund SLA Manual

Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) • Customer Care Operations Guide 2026

1. Order Lifecycles & State Transitions

Every order transitions through defined states: **PENDING** → **PROCESSING** (warehouse picking) → **SHIPPED** → **IN_TRANSIT** → **OUT_FOR_DELIVERY** → **DELIVERED**.

- 1.1 Cancellation Window:** Customers can cancel an order free of charge within **60 minutes of placement** while in PENDING status. Once status changes to PROCESSING, cancellation is locked and the customer must initiate a return post-delivery.
- 1.2 Address Modification:** Shipping address changes are only permitted within **30 minutes of placement**. Support agents cannot modify addresses once tracking numbers are generated.

2. 30-Day Return & Refund Guarantee Policy

- 2.1 Return Window:** Customers can initiate a return for eligible items within **30 calendar days of confirmed delivery**. Items must be in original packaging with tags intact.
- 2.2 Return Shipping Costs:** Free domestic returns within the continental US. International returns incur a flat **\$15 USD return shipping fee** deducted from the final refund.
- 2.3 Non-Returnable Items:** Personalized/custom-engraved items, clearance items marked Final Sale, gift cards, and opened consumable/software products.
- 2.4 Refund Processing Timelines:** Once returned goods arrive at our warehouse, inspection takes 1–2 business days. Refunds are issued based on payment method:

Original Payment Method	Processing SLA	Financial Institution Settlement	Notes
Credit / Debit Card (Visa, MC, Amex)	2–3 business days	3–5 additional business days	Appears on card statement
PayPal / Apple Pay / Google Pay	24 hours	Instant to 1 business day	Direct balance refund
Store Credit Voucher	Instantaneous	Available immediately	+10% bonus credit applied
Direct Bank Wire / ACH	3–5 business days	5–7 business days	Requires verified bank info

3. Damaged, Lost, or Defective Shipments

- 3.1 Damaged Upon Arrival:** Customers must report damaged shipments within **7 calendar days of delivery** by submitting clear photos of the damaged packaging and product. Support agents will immediately dispatch a priority replacement order at no charge.
- 3.2 Lost in Transit Protocols:** If tracking has not updated for **7 consecutive days (domestic)** or **14 days (international)**, the shipment is classified as Lost in Transit. Support agents can issue an immediate full refund or priority reshipment.

4. Customer Support Escalation Tiers & Response SLAs

Support Tier	Scope of Inquiries	First Response SLA	Resolution SLA Target
Tier 1 (General Customer Care)	Order tracking, return label generation, FAQ answers	< 2 hours (Chat: < 2 mins)	Within 12 hours
Tier 2 (Billing & Escalations)	Damaged goods, refund disputes, lost shipment claims	< 4 hours	Within 24 hours
Tier 3 (Enterprise & VIP Clients)	B2B bulk orders, custom SLAs, contract compliance	< 30 minutes	Within 4 hours